

Word family: **contest / contests / contested / contesting / contestant / contestable / incontestable / uncontested / contested / contestation**

Base word: contest

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Pronunciation / stress distinction:

* **CONtest** *(noun)* — competition; struggle

* con**TEST** *(verb)* — challenge; dispute; compete for

This stress shift is highly useful for learners.

Related forms:

* **contest** (n.) — 比賽；競賽；競爭；爭奪；較量

* **contest** (v.) — 競逐；爭奪；對.....提出異議；質疑；否認

* **contestant** (n.) — 參賽者；競賽者

* **contested** (adj./participle) — 有爭議的；有人爭奪的；受到挑戰的

* **uncontested** (adj.) — 無人爭奪的；沒有受到反對 / 質疑的

* **contestable** (adj.) — 可爭議的；可競爭的；可受到挑戰的

* **incontestable** (adj.) — 無可爭辯的；不可否認的

* **contestation** (n.) — 爭議；競爭；對某事的挑戰（較正式 / 學術）

Major useful extensions:

a contest, enter a contest, win/lose a contest, beauty contest, singing contest, writing contest, talent contest, sports contest, close contest, fierce contest, one-sided contest, competitive contest, contest between A and B, contest for control, contest for power, contest for leadership, leadership contest, election contest, electoral contest, a contest of strength, contest of wills, contest of ideas, contest of egos, no contest, make a contest of it, contest a decision, contest a claim, contest a charge, contest a will, contest an election, contest a seat, contest a result, contest liability, contest ownership, hotly contested, fiercely contested, closely contested, contested territory, contested issue, uncontested election, uncontested claim, contestable market, contestant, beauty-pageant contestant, game-show contestant.

Meaning in this passage

> A team meeting that should generate solutions may instead turn into a **contest of egos**, with people defending pride rather than pursuing results.

Here, **contest** means:

a struggle or competition between people trying to establish superiority or get their own way — 較量；爭勝；爭奪

A **contest of egos** means the meeting stops being about solving the problem and becomes:

- > “Whose ideas will win?”
- > “Who looks smartest?”
- > “Who has more influence?”
- > “Who refuses to back down?”

So **contest** here is figurative, not a formal competition with rules or prizes.

中文翻譯：

原本應該產生解決方案的團隊會議，反而可能變成一場**自尊 / 自我意識之間的較量**，大家忙於捍衛自己的面子和自尊，而不是追求成果。

So here:

contest of egos = 人們為了證明自己、維護自尊或壓過別人而互相較量

A. CONTEST = FORMAL COMPETITION

1. **contest = competition in which people try to win — 比賽；競賽**

The most common noun sense.

Practice 1

> She entered a photography **contest**.

她參加了一個攝影**比賽**。

Practice 2

> The school organised a writing contest.

學校舉辦了一個寫作**比賽**。

Practice 3

> He won the contest easily.

他輕鬆贏得了這場**競賽**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****contest = 多名參賽者互相競爭，希望取得勝利或獎項的活動****

2. **enter a contest — 參加比賽**

Practice 1

> She decided to ****enter the contest****.

她決定****參加比賽****。

Practice 2

> Anyone over eighteen can enter the contest.

任何十八歲以上的人都可以****參賽****。

3. **win a contest — 贏得比賽**

Practice 1

> Their team ****won the contest****.

他們的隊伍****贏得比賽****。

Practice 2

> The winner received a cash prize.

比賽****冠軍****獲得現金獎。

4. **lose a contest — 輸掉比賽**

Practice 1

> She was disappointed to ****lose the contest****.

她因****輸掉比賽****而失望。

Practice 2

> Losing one contest does not mean you lack ability.

輸掉一次**競賽**並不代表你沒有能力。

B. TYPES OF CONTEST

5. **writing contest — 寫作比賽**

Practice 1

> The library runs an annual **writing contest**.

圖書館每年舉辦一次**寫作比賽**。

Practice 2

> Her short story won the writing contest.

她的短篇故事贏得了**寫作比賽**。

6. **singing contest — 歌唱比賽**

Practice 1

> He entered a **singing contest**.

他參加了**歌唱比賽**。

Practice 2

> The singing contest attracted hundreds of applicants.

這個**歌唱比賽**吸引數百名申請者。

7. **talent contest — 才藝比賽**

Practice 1

> The school held a **talent contest**.

學校舉辦了一個**才藝比賽**。

Practice 2

> Contestants performed music, dance and comedy.

參賽者表演音樂、舞蹈和喜劇。

8. **beauty contest — 選美比賽**

Practice 1

> She once entered a **beauty contest**.

她曾參加**選美比賽**。

Practice 2

> The phrase “beauty contest” can also be used figuratively for a competition based heavily on presentation.

beauty contest 有時也可比喻指非常重視外在呈現的競爭。

9. **sports contest — 體育比賽；競賽**

Practice 1

> It was a closely fought **sporting contest**.

那是一場競爭激烈的**體育比賽**。

Practice 2

> Both sides played well throughout the contest.

雙方在整場**比賽**中都表現出色。

10. **quiz contest / competition — 問答比賽**

Practice 1

> Students took part in a science quiz contest.

學生參加了一個科學**問答比賽**。

Practice 2

> The contest tested general knowledge.

比賽測試**常識知識**。

C. CONTEST = COMPETITIVE MATCH / STRUGGLE

11. **contest = competitive struggle between two sides — 競爭；較量**

This is broader than a prize competition.

Practice 1

> The match became an intense **contest**.

比賽變成一場激烈的**較量**。

Practice 2

> The two teams were evenly matched throughout the contest.

兩隊在整場**較量**中實力相當。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contest = 雙方或多方為了取勝、取得優勢或控制權而進行的競爭****

12. **a close contest — 勢均力敵的比賽**

Practice 1

> It was a **close contest** until the final minute.

直到最後一分鐘，這都是一場**勢均力敵的比賽**。

Practice 2

> The result reflected how close the contest had been.

賽果反映這場**競賽非常接近**。

13. **a fierce contest — 激烈競爭**

Practice 1

> The two companies are in a **fierce contest** for market share.

兩間公司正在激烈**爭奪市場份額**。

Practice 2

> The championship became a fierce contest between the two teams.

錦標賽變成兩隊之間的**激烈較量**。

14. **one-sided contest — 一面倒的比賽**

Practice 1

> The match was a **one-sided contest**.

比賽是一場**一面倒的較量**。

Practice 2

> What was expected to be close became completely one-sided.

原本預計勢均力敵，最後卻變成**一面倒**。

15. **evenly matched contest — 勢均力敵的較量**

Practice 1

> It was an **evenly matched contest**.

那是一場**勢均力敵的較量**。

Practice 2

> Neither team dominated the contest.

沒有一隊能主導這場**比賽**。

D. CONTEST BETWEEN / AGAINST

16. **contest between A and B — A 與 B 之間的競爭 / 較量**

Practice 1

> The final became a **contest between two experienced teams**.

決賽成為兩支經驗豐富隊伍之間的**較量**。

Practice 2

> The debate became a contest between two competing visions.

辯論變成兩種不同願景之間的**競爭**。

17. **contest for something — 爭奪某事物**

Practice 1

> There is a fierce **contest for leadership**.

目前有一場激烈的**領導權爭奪**。

Practice 2

> Several firms are involved in the contest for market share.

數間公司正在**爭奪市場份額**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contest for X = 多方為了取得 X 而競爭****

E. CONTEST FOR POWER / CONTROL / LEADERSHIP

18. **contest for control — 控制權爭奪**

Practice 1

> The disagreement became a **contest for control**.

分歧演變成一場**控制權爭奪**。

Practice 2

> The merger triggered a contest for control of the combined company.

合併引發對新公司的**控制權之爭**。

19. **contest for power — 權力爭奪**

Practice 1

> The dispute became a **contest for power**.

爭議變成一場**權力爭奪**。

Practice 2

> Internal politics turned the discussion into a contest for influence and power.

內部政治令討論變成一場**影響力和權力之爭**。

20. **leadership contest — 領導職位競逐**

Practice 1

> Several candidates entered the **leadership contest**.

數名候選人參與**領導職位競逐**。

Practice 2

> The leadership contest exposed divisions within the organisation.

這場**領導權競逐**暴露了機構內部的分歧。

F. FIGURATIVE CONTEST

21. **contest of egos — 自我 / 自尊的較量**

This is the **exact expression in your passage**.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> The meeting may turn into a **contest of egos**.

會議可能變成一場**自我意識 / 自尊的較量**。

Practice 2

> What should have been a practical discussion became a contest of egos.

原本應該務實的討論，變成了一場**互相比高下的自尊之爭**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contest of egos = 各人爭相證明自己較重要、較正確或較有影響力的較量****

22. **contest of wills — 意志力的較量**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> The negotiation became a **contest of wills**.

談判變成一場**意志力的較量**。

Practice 2

> Neither side wanted to back down in the contest of wills.

在這場**意志較量**中，雙方都不願退讓。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contest of wills = 雙方都堅持自己的立場，看誰先讓步的較量****

23. **contest of strength — 力量較量**

Practice 1

> The battle became a **contest of strength**.

戰鬥變成一場**力量的較量**。

Practice 2

> Negotiation should not become a contest of strength.

談判不應變成一場**實力比拼**。

24. **contest of skill — 技巧較量**

Practice 1

> Chess is a **contest of skill and strategy**.

國際象棋是一場**技巧和策略的較量**。

Practice 2

> The final was a genuine contest of skill.

決賽是一場真正的**技巧比拼**。

25. **contest of ideas — 思想 / 觀點的較量**

Practice 1

> Healthy debate can be a **contest of ideas**.

健康的辯論可以是不同**思想之間的較量**。

Practice 2

> The discussion should remain a contest of ideas, not personalities.

討論應該是**觀點之爭**，而不是針對個人。

26. **contest of personalities — 個性 / 人物之間的較量**

Practice 1

> The debate became a **contest of personalities**.

辯論變成了**個人魅力 / 性格之間的較量**。

Practice 2

> The issue itself was forgotten as the discussion became a contest of personalities.

當討論變成人與人之間的**較量**後，問題本身反而被忘記。

G. “NO CONTEST”

27. **no contest = one side is clearly superior — 毫無懸念；根本無得比**

Informal.

Practice 1

> When it comes to battery life, it's **no contest**.

說到電池續航力，結果**毫無懸念**。

Practice 2

> Between the two designs, it's no contest—the second is much clearer.

兩個設計相比，**根本不用比**——第二個清楚得多。

MCQ-ready definition:

no contest = informal: 一方明顯優勝，幾乎沒有真正競爭

28. **make a contest of it — 令比賽變得有競爭性**

Practice 1

> The weaker team scored twice and **made a contest of it**.

實力較弱的一隊連入兩球，令比賽**重新有懸念**。

Practice 2

> They lost, but at least they made a contest of it.

他們雖然輸了，但至少令比賽**不是一面倒**。

H. VERB: CONTEST = COMPETE FOR

29. **contest something = compete to win it — 競逐；爭奪**

Verb pronunciation: con**TEST**

Practice 1

> Several athletes **contested the final**.

數名運動員**參加決賽競逐**。

Practice 2

> Three teams are contesting the championship.

三支隊伍正**爭奪錦標**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contest X = 與其他人競爭，希望贏得 X

30. **contest a title — 爭奪冠軍 / 錦標**

Practice 1

> The two players will **contest the title** tomorrow.

兩名選手明天會**爭奪冠軍**。

Practice 2

> Four teams remain in contention to contest the championship.

仍有四隊爭取**競逐錦標**。

31. **contest a race / match / final — 參與競逐某比賽**

Practice 1

> Six runners **contested the final**.

六名跑手**參加決賽競逐**。

Practice 2

> The teams contested a close match.

兩隊進行了一場激烈的**比賽**。

I. VERB: CONTEST AN ELECTION / SEAT

32. **contest an election — 參選；角逐選舉**

Practice 1

> Several candidates **contested the election**.

數名候選人**參加選舉競逐**。

Practice 2

> The party decided not to contest the election.

該政黨決定不**參選**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contest an election = 作為候選人 / 政黨參與選舉競爭

33. **contest a seat — 競逐議席**

Practice 1

> Three candidates are **contesting the seat**.

三名候選人正在**競逐該議席**。

Practice 2

> She decided to contest a different seat.

她決定**競逐另一個議席**。

34. **closely contested election** — **競爭激烈的選舉**

Practice 1

> It was a **closely contested election**.

那是一場**競爭非常激烈的選舉**。

Practice 2

> Several districts were closely contested.

數個選區的**競爭十分接近**。

J. VERB: CHALLENGE / DISPUTE

35. **contest something** = challenge its truth, legality, or validity — 對.....提出異議；質疑；爭議

A major verb branch.

Practice 1

> The company **contested the decision**.

公司對該決定**提出異議**。

Practice 2

> He contested the accuracy of the report.

他**質疑報告的準確性**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contest X = 正式表示 X 不正確、不合法、無效或不應被接受****

36. ****contest a decision — 對決定提出異議****

Practice 1

> Employees may ****contest the decision**** through the appeals process.

員工可以透過上訴程序****對決定提出異議****。

Practice 2

> She decided to contest the disciplinary decision.

她決定****挑戰該紀律處分決定****。

37. ****contest a claim — 對主張 / 索償提出異議****

Practice 1

> The insurer ****contested the claim****.

保險公司對該****索償提出異議****。

Practice 2

> His account of events was contested by several witnesses.

他對事件的說法受到數名證人****質疑****。

38. ****contest an allegation — 否認 / 反駁指控****

Practice 1

> She strongly ****contested the allegation****.

她強烈****反駁該指控****。

Practice 2

> The allegations remain contested.

這些指控仍然**存在爭議**。

39. **contest a charge — 對控罪 / 費用提出異議**

Context determines meaning.

Legal:

> He **contested the charge**.

> 他對控罪**提出抗辯 / 否認控罪**。

Billing:

> She contested the charge on her credit card.

> 她對信用卡上的該筆**收費提出異議**。

Same phrase, different **charge**.

40. **contest a fine / penalty — 對罰款 / 處罰提出異議**

Practice 1

> The driver decided to **contest the fine**.

駕駛者決定**對罰款提出異議**。

Practice 2

> The company contested the penalty.

公司**挑戰該項處罰**。

41. **contest a result — 質疑 / 挑戰結果**

Practice 1

> The team **contested** the result.

團隊對結果**提出異議**。

Practice 2

> The result was formally contested.

結果受到正式**質疑 / 挑戰**。

K. LEGAL: CONTEST A WILL

42. **contest a will** — 對遺囑提出法律爭議

A major legal collocation.

Practice 1

> A family member decided to **contest the will**.

一名家庭成員決定對遺囑**提出法律爭議**。

Practice 2

> A will may be contested on certain legal grounds.

遺囑可以基於某些法律理由受到**爭議 / 挑戰**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contest a will = 透過法律程序質疑遺囑的有效性、內容或執行

43. **contested will** — 有爭議的遺囑

Practice 1

> The estate became involved in a **contested will** dispute.

遺產涉及一宗**遺囑爭議**。

Practice 2

> Contested wills can lead to lengthy proceedings.

****有爭議的遺囑**可能引致長時間的法律程序。**

L. LEGAL / LIABILITY / OWNERSHIP

44. ****contest liability — 對責任提出異議****

Practice 1

> The company ****contested liability**** for the damage.

公司對損害的法律責任****提出異議****。

Practice 2

> Liability remains contested.

責任誰屬仍然****存在爭議****。

45. ****contest ownership — 爭議所有權****

Practice 1

> Two parties ****contested ownership of the land****.

雙方就土地****所有權發生爭議****。

Practice 2

> The ownership claim was contested in court.

該項所有權主張在法院受到****挑戰****。

46. ****contest jurisdiction / authority — 質疑管轄權 / 權限****

Practice 1

> The defendant ****contested the court's jurisdiction****.

被告****質疑法院的管轄權****。

Practice 2

> The agency's authority was contested.

該機構的權限受到**質疑**。

M. CONTESTED = SUBJECT TO COMPETITION

47. **contested = competed for by more than one person — 有人爭奪的**

Practice 1

> It was a **contested leadership position**.

這是一個**多人競逐的領導職位**。

Practice 2

> Every available seat was contested.

每個可供競逐的席位都**有人參與競爭**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contested = 有兩方或以上互相競爭，希望取得某物的****

48. **hotly contested — 競爭激烈的；爭議激烈的**

A major collocation with **two possible readings**.

Competition:

> a **hotly contested final**

> 競爭激烈的決賽

Dispute:

> a **hotly contested issue**

> 爭議非常激烈的問題

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****hotly contested = 有非常激烈的競爭或爭議****

49. ****fiercely contested — 激烈爭奪 / 激烈爭議****

Practice 1

> The championship was ****fiercely contested****.

錦標受到各方****激烈爭奪****。

Practice 2

> The interpretation remains fiercely contested.

這個解釋仍然受到****激烈爭議****。

50. ****closely contested — 勢均力敵地競爭****

Practice 1

> The final was ****closely contested****.

決賽****競爭非常接近****。

Practice 2

> It was a closely contested race.

那是一場****勢均力敵的比賽****。

N. CONTESTED = DISPUTED

51. ****contested issue — 有爭議的問題****

Practice 1

> This remains a ****contested issue****.

這仍然是一個****有爭議的問題****。

Practice 2

> The meaning of the term is contested.

該詞的含義仍然**存在爭議**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contested = 有人不同意其正確性、解釋、合法性或權利歸屬的

52. **contested claim — 有爭議的主張**

Practice 1

> The report contains several **contested claims**.

報告包含數項**有爭議的主張**。

Practice 2

> The claim has been contested by researchers.

該主張受到研究人員**質疑**。

53. **contested territory — 爭議地區；爭奪中的地區**

Practice 1

> The map marks the area as **contested territory**.

地圖把該區標示為**爭議地區**。

Practice 2

> Control of the territory remained contested.

該地區的控制權仍然**存在爭奪**。

Context may involve either:

* disputed sovereignty/ownership,

* active struggle for control.

54. **contested concept / interpretation — 有爭議的概念 / 解釋**

Practice 1

> “Fairness” can be a **contested concept**.

「公平」可以是一個**存在不同理解的爭議概念**。

Practice 2

> The historical interpretation remains contested.

這個歷史解讀仍然**存在爭議**。

O. UNCONTESTED

55. **uncontested = not opposed or challenged — 無人反對 / 未受質疑的**

Practice 1

> The claim went **uncontested**.

該主張**沒有人提出異議**。

Practice 2

> His appointment was uncontested.

他的任命**沒有受到反對**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****uncontested = 沒有人提出反對、異議或競爭****

56. **uncontested election / position — 無人競逐的選舉 / 職位**

Practice 1

> The position was **uncontested**.

該職位**沒有其他人競逐**。

Practice 2

> She was returned unopposed in an uncontested race.

她在**沒有對手競逐**的情況下當選。

57. **uncontested claim — 無爭議的主張 / 索償**

Practice 1

> The facts were largely **uncontested**.

事實大致上**沒有爭議**。

Practice 2

> The claim remained uncontested.

該主張一直**未受到挑戰**。

58. **uncontested divorce — 無爭議離婚**

A common legal term in some jurisdictions.

Practice 1

> They applied for an **uncontested divorce**.

他們申請**無爭議離婚**。

Practice 2

> In an uncontested divorce, the parties do not dispute the key terms.

在**無爭議離婚**中，雙方對主要條件沒有重大爭議。

Exact procedure varies by jurisdiction.

P. CONTESTABLE

59. **contestable = capable of being disputed — 可爭議的；可受到質疑的**

Practice 1

> That assumption is **contestable**.

那個假設是**可以受到質疑的**。

Practice 2

> The conclusion is highly contestable.

這項結論**很有爭議 / 可以被挑戰**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contestable = 並非確定無疑，而是有合理空間被反對或質疑的

60. **contestable decision / claim — 可挑戰的決定 / 主張**

Practice 1

> The interpretation is contestable.

這個解釋**可以提出異議**。

Practice 2

> Some parts of the argument remain contestable.

論點中的某些部分仍然**值得商榷**。

Q. CONTESTABLE MARKET

61. **contestable market — 可競爭市場**

A standard economics term.

Practice 1

> Economists analyse whether the industry is a **contestable market**.

經濟學家分析這個行業是否屬於**可競爭市場**。

Practice 2

> A market may be highly contestable if entry and exit are relatively easy.

如果企業進出市場相對容易，市場可能具有高度**可競爭性**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contestable market = 即使現有企業數目不多，只要新競爭者較容易進入和退出，現有企業仍受到潛在競爭壓力的市場

62. **market contestability — 市場可競爭性**

Practice 1

> Low barriers to entry increase **market contestability**.

較低的進入壁壘會提高**市場可競爭性**。

Practice 2

> Contestability is different from simply counting the number of firms.

可競爭性並不等於單純計算市場中有多少家公司。

R. INCONTESTABLE

63. **incontestable = impossible to reasonably dispute — 無可爭辯的；不可否認的**

Formal.

Practice 1

> The evidence provides **incontestable proof**.

證據提供了**無可爭辯的證明**。

Practice 2

> Her influence on the field is incontestable.

她對該領域的影響**無可否認**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****incontestable = 證據或事實十分明確，幾乎沒有合理爭議空間的****

64. ****incontestable fact — 無可爭議的事實****

Practice 1

> It is an ****incontestable fact**** that the deadline was missed.

截止日期確實被錯過，這是****無可爭議的事實****。

Practice 2

> Very few conclusions are entirely ****incontestable****.

很少結論是完全****無可爭辯的****。

S. CONTESTANT

65. ****contestant = person taking part in a contest — 參賽者****

Practice 1

> Twenty ****contestants**** entered the competition.

二十名****參賽者****參加比賽。

Practice 2

> Each contestant had five minutes to perform.

每名****參賽者****有五分鐘表演時間。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****contestant = 參加比賽、競賽或遊戲節目並希望勝出的人****

66. ****game-show contestant — 遊戲節目參賽者****

Practice 1

> The **contestant** answered all ten questions correctly.

這名**參賽者**答對全部十條問題。

Practice 2

> Contestants compete for a cash prize.

參賽者競逐現金獎。

67. **beauty-pageant contestant** — 選美參賽者

Practice 1

> The contestants appeared on stage.

選美參賽者上台亮相。

Practice 2

> Each contestant represented a different region.

每名**參賽者**代表不同地區。

T. CONTESTANT VS COMPETITOR

68. **contestant** = entrant in a defined contest — 特定比賽的參賽者

contestant

especially natural in:

- * game shows,
- * talent contests,
- * beauty pageants,
- * competitions with clearly identified entrants.

competitor

broader:

- * sport,
- * business,
- * any person/company competing.

> quiz-show contestant
> 問答節目參賽者

> business competitor
> 商業競爭者

U. CONTESTATION

69. **contestation = act/process of disputing or competing — 爭議；挑戰；競逐**

Formal/academic.

Practice 1

> The policy became a site of political and social **contestation**.

該政策成為社會各方**爭議和角力**的焦點。

Practice 2

> The meaning of the concept is open to contestation.

這個概念的含義可以受到**爭論和挑戰**。

MCQ-ready definition:

contestation = 對權利、解釋、權力或主張持續進行爭議或挑戰的過程

This is much less common in ordinary conversation than:

- * dispute,
- * disagreement,
- * competition.

V. NO CONTEST — LEGAL USE

70. **no contest = plea not contesting a criminal charge — 不爭辯抗辯**

A specialist US legal usage.

Practice 1

> The defendant entered a **no-contest plea**.

被告提出**不爭辯抗辯**。

Practice 2

> “No contest” has a specific legal meaning in some jurisdictions.

no contest 在某些司法制度中具有特定法律含義。

MCQ-ready definition:

no-contest plea = 被告不正式承認有罪，但也不對控罪進行抗辯的一種法律答辯；具體法律效果視司法管轄區而定

This is completely different from informal:

> “It's no contest.”

> = 根本無得比。

W. IMPORTANT PRONUNCIATION DISTINCTION

71. **CONtest** vs **conTEST**

Noun:

> a **CONtest**

> 一場比賽 / 較量

Verb:

> to **conTEST** a decision

> 對決定提出異議

This follows a useful English pattern where some noun/verb pairs differ in stress.

Important distinction 1: **contest** vs **competition**

competition

very broad:

- * event,
- * competitive situation,
- * rivalry.

contest

often a specific event or a clear struggle between sides.

> a writing contest

> 寫作比賽

> competition between companies

> 公司之間的競爭

A contest is usually a kind of competition, but not all competition is a contest.

Important distinction 2: **contest vs race**

race

literally:

competition to be fastest.

Figuratively:

competition to achieve something first.

contest

broader:

skill,

votes,

power,

ideas,

appearance,

sport, etc.

Important distinction 3: **contest vs match**

match

especially one scheduled sporting game between players/teams.

contest

emphasizes competition itself.

> football match

> 足球比賽

> a closely fought contest

> 一場勢均力敵的較量

The same sporting event can be both.

Important distinction 4: **contest vs tournament**

contest

one competition/event.

tournament

series of matches/rounds leading to a winner.

One tournament can contain many contests or matches.

Important distinction 5: **contest vs challenge**

contest noun

competition/struggle.

challenge noun

difficult task or invitation to compete.

contest verb

can mean challenge the validity of something.

So:

- > contest a decision
- > ≈ challenge a decision.

But:

- > a difficult challenge
- > ≠ contest.

Important distinction 6: **contest vs rivalry**

contest

specific competitive struggle/event.

rivalry

ongoing competitive relationship.

- > one contest
- > 一次較量

- > a ten-year rivalry
- > 長達十年的競爭關係

Important distinction 7: **contest vs conflict**

contest

competition over who wins/prevails.

conflict

broader clash of:

- * interests,
- * views,
- * people,
- * groups.

A conflict may become a contest for control, but not every conflict has a clear “winner”.

Important distinction 8: **contest vs battle**

battle

stronger, often military or highly confrontational metaphor.

contest

more neutral competitive framing.

> contest of ideas

> 觀點較量

> battle of ideas

> 思想激戰

The latter sounds more dramatic.

Important distinction 9: **contest of egos vs disagreement**

disagreement

people hold different views.

contest of egos

people are also trying to protect status, pride, or superiority.

This is crucial in your passage.

Two people can disagree professionally **without** creating a contest of egos.

Important distinction 10: **contest of egos vs clash of personalities**

clash of personalities

personal styles/temperaments do not work well together.

contest of egos

people actively compete for status, recognition, or dominance.

They can occur together but are not identical.

Important distinction 11: **contest of wills vs contest of egos**

contest of wills

who will give way first?

contest of egos

who will look stronger/right/more important?

The first stresses stubborn determination.

The second stresses self-image/status.

Important distinction 12: **contest for power vs struggle for power**

Very close.

contest

slightly more neutral/competitive.

struggle

emphasizes difficulty and conflict.

Important distinction 13: **contest as verb vs compete**

compete for X

ordinary structure:

> compete for the title

contest X

more concise/formal:

> contest the title

In some contexts **contest** is especially common in sports, elections, and formal writing.

Important distinction 14: **contest a decision vs disagree with a decision**

disagree with

hold a different opinion.

contest

actively challenge its validity/correctness, often through a formal process.

> disagree with the decision

> 不同意決定

> contest the decision

> **正式挑戰該決定**

Important distinction 15: **contest vs object**

From your **objective/object/objection** family:

object to a decision

express opposition.

contest a decision

challenge its correctness, legality or validity.

Example:

> I object to the policy.

> 我反對政策。

> I contested the disciplinary decision.

> 我正式對紀律處分**提出挑戰 / 申訴**。

Contest often sounds more formal and action-oriented.

Important distinction 16: **contest vs dispute**

dispute a claim

say it is incorrect / challenge it.

contest a claim

very similar, often slightly more formal/legal.

> dispute a bill

> 質疑帳單

> contest liability

> 爭議法律責任

They overlap heavily.

Important distinction 17: **contest vs deny**

deny

state that something is untrue or that you did not do it.

contest

challenge it and provide/seek grounds for disagreement.

> deny the allegation

> 否認指控

> contest the allegation

> 對指控**提出爭議 / 反駁**

One can contest something without flatly denying every part.

Important distinction 18: **contest a will**

This is a fixed legal collocation.

It does ****not**** mean:

> compete to “win” the will.

It means:

****legally challenge the validity or terms of the will****

Important distinction 19: ****contested = competitive vs disputed****

Two major readings:

Competition:

> a contested seat

> 有人競逐的席位

Dispute:

> contested evidence

> 有爭議的證據

Context decides.

Important distinction 20: ****hotly contested****

Also has both readings:

****hotly contested match****

競爭激烈

****hotly contested claim****

爭議激烈

Same form, different core relationship.

Important distinction 21: ****uncontested vs unanimous****

uncontested

nobody opposed/competed.

unanimous

everyone explicitly agrees.

These are not the same.

A proposal may be uncontested simply because nobody raised an objection; that does not necessarily mean everyone strongly supported it.

Important distinction 22: **uncontested vs unopposed**

They overlap strongly.

unopposed

no opponent/resistance.

uncontested

no competing candidate or formal challenge/dispute.

In elections/positions both may be very close.

Important distinction 23: **contestable vs controversial**

contestable

can reasonably be challenged.

controversial

actually causes significant disagreement.

A claim may be contestable even if nobody currently contests it.

Important distinction 24: **contestable vs contested**

contestable

potential:

> can be challenged.

contested

actual:

> is being challenged/disputed.

Excellent distinction:

> contestable claim

> 可被質疑的主張

> contested claim

> 已受到質疑的主張

Important distinction 25: **incontestable vs uncontested**

Very different.

incontestable

cannot reasonably be disputed.

uncontested

nobody happens to be disputing it.

Something can be uncontested but still contestable.

Important distinction 26: **contestant vs participant**

participant

anyone taking part.

contestant

specifically takes part **in order to compete**.

Every contestant is a participant, but not every participant is a contestant.

Important distinction 27: **contestant vs candidate**

contestant

competition participant.

candidate

person being considered for:

- * job,
- * office,
- * election,
- * qualification.

A candidate may also be a contestant in an electoral contest, but the words focus on different roles.

Important distinction 28: **contestant vs competitor**

contestant

especially a named entrant in a formal contest/show.

competitor

broader and especially natural in:

- * sports,
- * business,
- * markets.

> game-show contestant

> business competitor

Important distinction 29: **competition vs contest of egos**

Your passage deliberately chooses **contest**, not merely **competition**.

Why?

Because **contest of egos** evokes:

two or more people trying to defeat or outdo one another personally.

It is more vivid than:

> competition of egos ❌

The fixed natural collocation is:

> **contest of egos**

Important distinction 30: **no contest = two separate senses**

Informal comparison:

> It's no contest.

> 毫無懸念 / 根本無得比。

Legal:

> plead no contest

> 提出不爭辯抗辯。

Do not merge them.

Important distinction 31: **contest in your passage**

The full sentence is:

> A team meeting that should generate solutions may instead turn into a **contest of egos**, with people defending pride rather than pursuing results.

The writer is contrasting:

what the meeting should be:

> collaborative problem-solving

with:

what it can become:

> personal competition over status and pride.

So **contest** here carries three important ideas:

1. **opposition** — people take sides;
2. **competition** — each person wants to prevail;
3. **personal status** — winning matters more than solving the problem.

That is why **contest of egos** is stronger and more precise than merely saying:

> “an argument.”

Family-extension note

The **contest** family divides into several major modern branches:

1. **formal competition**

- * enter a contest
- * win a contest
- * talent contest

2. **competitive match/struggle**

- * close contest
- * fierce contest

3. **competition for something**

- * contest for control
- * leadership contest

4. **figurative struggle**

- * contest of egos
- * contest of wills

* contest of ideas

5. **no contest**

* obvious superiority

6. **verb: compete**

* contest a title

* contest a final

7. **electoral competition**

* contest an election

* contest a seat

8. **verb: challenge/dispute**

* contest a decision

* contest a claim

* contest a result

9. **legal challenge**

* contest a will

* contest liability

10. **contested = competed for**

* contested seat

11. **contested = disputed**

* contested claim

* contested issue

12. **uncontested**

* uncontested claim

* uncontested position

13. **contestable**

* contestable claim

* contestable market

14. **incontestable**

* incontestable evidence

15. **participant**

* contestant

16. **formal academic noun**

* contestation

For your passage, the exact branch is:

contest = a competitive struggle in which people try to establish superiority over one another

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
contest (competition)	比賽；競賽	formal competition	
enter a contest	參加比賽	participate	
win a contest	贏得比賽	victory	
writing contest	寫作比賽	competition type	
singing contest	歌唱比賽	competition type	
talent contest	才藝比賽	competition type	
beauty contest	選美比賽	competition type	
contest (struggle)	較量；競爭	competitive struggle	
close contest	勢均力敵的比賽	close competition	
fierce contest	激烈競爭	intense competition	
one-sided contest	一面倒的比賽	unequal competition	
contest between A and B	A、B 之間的較量	rivalry	
contest for X	爭奪 X	sought prize/control	
contest for control	控制權爭奪	control	
contest for power	權力爭奪	power	
leadership contest	領導權競逐	leadership	
contest of egos	自尊 / 自我的較量	status/pride	
contest of wills	意志較量	persistence	
contest of strength	力量較量	strength	
contest of skill	技巧較量	skill	
contest of ideas	思想 / 觀點較量	ideas	
no contest (informal)	毫無懸念；根本無得比	obvious winner	
make a contest of it	令比賽有懸念	become competitive	

contest (verb: compete)	競逐；爭奪	compete	
contest a title	爭奪冠軍	sport	
contest a final	參與決賽競逐	sport	
contest an election	參選	election	
contest a seat	競逐議席	election	
contest (challenge)	質疑；提出異議	dispute	
contest a decision	對決定提出異議	challenge	
contest a claim	質疑主張 / 索償	dispute	
contest an allegation	反駁指控	dispute	
contest a charge	抗辯控罪 / 質疑收費	context-dependent	
contest a result	質疑結果	challenge	
contest a will	對遺囑提出爭議	law	
contest liability	對責任提出異議	law	
contest ownership	爭議所有權	law	
contested (competitive)	有人競逐的	competition	
hotly contested	激烈競爭 / 爭議	strong contest	
fiercely contested	激烈爭奪 / 爭議	intense	
closely contested	勢均力敵	close	
contested issue	有爭議的問題	dispute	
contested claim	有爭議的主張	dispute	
contested territory	爭議 / 爭奪地區	territory	
uncontested	無人競逐 / 沒有爭議的	no challenge	
uncontested claim	無爭議主張	no objection	
uncontested divorce	無爭議離婚	law	
contestable	可爭議 / 可競爭的	can be challenged	
contestable market	可競爭市場	economics	
market contestability	市場可競爭性	economics	
incontestable	無可爭辯的	cannot reasonably dispute	
contestant	參賽者	person competing	
game-show contestant	遊戲節目參賽者	competition	
contestation	爭議；挑戰；角力	formal process	
no-contest plea	不爭辯抗辯	law	

For your original sentence

> A team meeting that should generate solutions may instead turn into a **contest of egos**, with people defending pride rather than pursuing results.

Here:

contest of egos = 原本應合作解決問題的人，開始互相比高下、維護自己的地位和自尊，希望自己的意見勝過別人的意見**

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 原本應該產生解決方案的團隊會議，反而可能變成一場**自我與自尊之間的較量**，大家忙於捍衛自己的面子和尊嚴，而不是追求實際成果。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

- > **contest** = **爭勝 / 較量，看誰能勝出**
- > **competition** = 廣義競爭
- > **conflict** = 利益、立場或人物之間的衝突
- > **rivalry** = 持續存在的競爭關係
- > **disagreement** = 意見不同
- > **contest of wills** = 看誰先讓步的意志較量
- > **contest of egos** = **看誰較有地位、較正確、較不肯低頭的自尊較量**

And the key distinction from your earlier **object/objection** family is:

- > **object to X** = 表示反對 X
- > **contest X** = **正式挑戰 X 的正確性、有效性、結果或權利**
- > **a contest** = 比賽 / 爭奪 / 較量

So **contest** is especially rich because the same underlying idea—**two sides refusing to yield and trying to prevail**—connects its competition, figurative-struggle, electoral, and dispute meanings.